

Word family: direct / directs / directed / directing / directly / direction / directional / directive / director / directorship / redirect / misdirect / indirect / indirectly

Base word: direct

Part of speech: mainly adjective, verb, and adverbial use in some fixed patterns

Related forms:

- **direct** (adj.) — 直接的; 直達的; 直率的; 明確的; 親身的; 直系的
- **direct** (v.) — 指引; 指揮; 管理; 導向; 把.....針對; 執導
- **directly** (adv.) — 直接地; 立即; 正好; 明確地
- **direction** (n.) — 方向; 指示; 方針; 管理 / 指導
- **directional** (adj.) — 方向性的; 指示方向的
- **directive** (n./adj.) — 指令; 正式指示; 指令性的
- **director** (n.) — 董事; 主管; 導演
- **directorship** (n.) — 董事職位
- **redirect** (v.) — 重新導向; 轉送
- **misdirect** (v.) — 指錯方向; 錯誤引導
- **indirect** (adj.) — 間接的; 不直截了當的
- **indirectly** (adv.) — 間接地

Major useful extensions:

direct person, direct manner, direct answer, direct question, direct criticism, direct communication, direct approach, direct contact, direct access, direct connection, direct link, direct result, direct consequence, direct cause, direct effect, direct evidence, direct experience, direct involvement, direct responsibility, direct control, direct supervision, direct report, direct manager, direct descendant, direct ancestor, direct route, direct flight, direct train, direct service, direct line, direct path, direct sunlight, direct hit, direct speech, direct quotation, direct object, direct current, direct debit, direct deposit, direct payment, direct tax, direct cost, direct investment, direct marketing, direct sales, direct channel, direct democracy, direct action, direct proportion, direct variation, direct someone to a place, direct someone to do something, direct attention to, direct a question at/to, direct criticism at, direct resources towards, direct traffic, direct operations, direct a company/team, direct a film/play, directly related, directly responsible, directly involved, directly opposite, directly proportional, directly to, go/fly direct, deal direct.

Meaning in this passage

Some employees are **direct** and fast-paced; others are cautious and reflective.

Here, **direct** is an **adjective** describing a person's communication style.

It means:

speaking clearly and openly without avoiding the main point — 直接的; 直率的; 說話坦白的

A **direct** employee may say exactly what they think or need, without much softening or indirect wording.

中文翻譯：

有些員工說話直接、直率，做事節奏快；另一些則較謹慎、較善於反思。

So here:

direct = 表達方式直截了當，不繞圈子，也不過度婉轉

It does **not automatically** mean rude.

A. DIRECT = STRAIGHTFORWARD IN COMMUNICATION

1. direct = straightforward and open — 直接的; 直率的

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

Some employees are **direct** and fast-paced.

有些員工說話直接、直率，做事節奏快。

Practice 2

She is very **direct** when giving feedback.

她給意見時非常直接。

Practice 3

He tends to be direct rather than diplomatic.

他往往比較直截了當，而不是十分婉轉。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct = 說話或表達時不繞圈子，清楚說出真正意思

2. direct person — 說話直接的人

Practice 1

She's a very **direct person**.

她是一個非常直率的人。

Practice 2

Direct people may be misunderstood as unfriendly in some cultures.

在某些文化中，說話直接的人可能被誤解為不友善。

3. direct manner — 直接的說話／處事方式

Practice 1

His **direct manner** can be useful in emergencies.

他直截了當的處事方式在緊急情況下可能很有用。

Practice 2

Some colleagues found her direct manner uncomfortable.

有些同事覺得她的直接風格令人不太自在。

4. direct answer — 直接回答

Practice 1

I asked for a **direct answer**.

我要求一個直接明確的回答。

Practice 2

He avoided giving a direct answer.

他避免作出直接回答。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct answer = 清楚回應問題本身、不迴避重點的回答

5. direct question — 直接問題

Practice 1

She asked him a **direct question** about the delay.

她就延誤問題向他提出一個直接問題。

Practice 2

Direct questions sometimes produce clearer answers.

直接提問有時能得到更清楚的答案。

6. direct criticism — 直接批評

Practice 1

He made some **direct criticism** of management.

他對管理層作出了一些直接批評。

Practice 2

Direct criticism can feel harsh if it is not expressed carefully.

如果表達方式不夠小心，直接批評可能令人覺得尖銳。

7. direct communication — 直接溝通

Practice 1

Direct communication can prevent misunderstandings.

直接溝通可以防止誤會。

Practice 2

The team encouraged direct communication between departments.

團隊鼓勵不同部門之間進行直接溝通。

8. be direct with someone — 對某人直言

Practice 1

I'll be **direct with you**.

我就直接跟你說吧。

Practice 2

Managers sometimes need to be direct with underperforming staff.

管理人員有時需要對表現欠佳的員工直言不諱。

MCQ-ready definition:

be direct with someone = 不婉轉隱瞞，而清楚告訴對方真正情況或意見

B. DIRECT = WITHOUT INTERMEDIARY

9. direct = without another person/thing in between — 直接的；不經中間環節的

A major abstract branch.

Practice 1

Customers have **direct access** to support staff.

顧客可以直接聯絡支援人員。

Practice 2

We maintain direct contact with suppliers.

我們與供應商保持直接聯繫。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct = 中間沒有經過其他人、組織、步驟或媒介

10. direct contact — 直接接觸／聯絡

Practice 1

The manager has **direct contact** with customers.

經理與顧客有直接聯絡。

Practice 2

Avoid direct contact with the chemical.

避免與化學品直接接觸。

Note the same phrase works socially and physically.

11. direct access — 直接存取；直接接觸機會

Practice 1

Employees have **direct access** to the database.

員工可以直接存取資料庫。

Practice 2

Senior staff have direct access to the CEO.

資深員工可以直接聯絡行政總裁。

12. direct connection — 直接連接／直接關係

Practice 1

There is a **direct connection** between the two systems.

兩個系統之間有直接連接。

Practice 2

Researchers found a direct connection between workload and stress.

研究人員發現工作量和壓力之間存在直接關聯。

13. direct link — 直接聯繫; 直接連結

Practice 1

There is no proven **direct link** between the two events.

目前沒有證據證明兩件事之間有直接關係。

Practice 2

The page provides a direct link to the form.

該頁面提供表格的直接連結。

14. direct relationship — 直接關係

Practice 1

There is a direct relationship between effort and output in some tasks.

在某些任務中，努力和產出之間存在直接關係。

Practice 2

The two factors are directly related.

這兩個因素直接相關。

C. DIRECT CAUSE / RESULT / EFFECT

15. direct cause — 直接原因

Practice 1

Poor communication was the **direct cause** of the error.

溝通不良是錯誤的直接原因。

Practice 2

The investigation found no single direct cause.

調查沒有發現單一的直接成因。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct cause = 不需經過其他主要中介因素便造成某結果的原因

16. direct result — 直接結果

Practice 1

The delay was a **direct result of poor planning**.

延誤是規劃不善的直接結果。

Practice 2

The improvement was a direct result of clearer roles.

改善是角色更清晰的直接結果。

17. direct consequence — 直接後果

Practice 1

Lower morale was a **direct consequence** of the conflict.

士氣下降是衝突的直接後果。

Practice 2

One direct consequence was slower decision-making.

其中一個直接後果是決策變慢。

18. direct effect / impact — 直接影響

Practice 1

The policy had a **direct effect** on staffing levels.

政策對員工人數有直接影響。

Practice 2

The change directly affected the team.

這項改變直接影響了團隊。

D. DIRECT EXPERIENCE / KNOWLEDGE

19. direct experience — 親身經驗

Practice 1

She has **direct experience of managing large teams**.

她有管理大型團隊的親身經驗。

Practice 2

Direct experience is different from second-hand knowledge.

親身經驗與間接得來的知識不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct experience = 自己親身經歷而得到的經驗, 而不是從別人得知

20. direct knowledge — 直接／第一手知識

Practice 1

He had **direct knowledge** of the incident.

他對事件有第一手了解。

Practice 2

I have no direct knowledge of what happened.

我對事情經過沒有親身／直接了解。

21. direct evidence — 直接證據

Practice 1

There was no **direct evidence** linking him to the mistake.

沒有直接證據把他與該錯誤聯繫起來。

Practice 2

Direct evidence can establish a fact without requiring the same inferential step as circumstantial evidence.

直接證據可直接證明某項事實, 而不需要同樣程度的推論。

E. DIRECT INVOLVEMENT / RESPONSIBILITY

22. direct involvement — 直接參與

Practice 1

She had **direct involvement** in the project.

她直接參與了這個項目。

Practice 2

The director denied direct involvement in the decision.

該主管否認直接參與該決定。

23. direct responsibility — 直接責任

Practice 1

The manager has **direct responsibility** for the team.

經理對團隊負有直接責任。

Practice 2

He was not directly responsible for the error.

他並非對該錯誤負有直接責任。

24. direct control — 直接控制

Practice 1

Head office maintains **direct control** over spending.

總部對開支保持直接控制。

Practice 2

Local managers have direct control of day-to-day operations.

本地管理人員直接管理日常營運。

25. direct supervision — 直接監督

Practice 1

New staff work under **direct supervision**.

新員工在直接監督下工作。

Practice 2

The task requires direct supervision by a qualified engineer.

這項工作需要合資格工程師直接監督。

F. DIRECT REPORT / REPORTING LINE

26. direct report = employee who reports directly to a manager — 直接下屬

A major workplace noun expression.

Practice 1

She has six **direct reports**.

她有六名直接下屬。

Practice 2

Managers should meet regularly with their direct reports.

管理人員應定期與自己的直接下屬會面。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct report = 在組織架構上直接向某一經理匯報的員工

27. report directly to someone — 直接向某人匯報

Practice 1

She **reports directly** to the CEO.

她直接向行政總裁匯報。

Practice 2

The compliance team reports directly to the board.

合規團隊直接向董事會匯報。

28. direct manager / supervisor — 直屬經理／主管

Practice 1

Speak to your **direct manager** first.

先與你的直屬經理溝通。

Practice 2

Your direct supervisor will review the work.

你的直屬主管會審核工作。

G. DIRECT = STRAIGHT ROUTE / NO STOPS

29. direct route — 直接路線；最直接路徑

Practice 1

This is the most **direct route** to the station.

這是前往車站最直接的路線。

Practice 2

We took a direct route through the city.

我們採取了一條直接路線穿過城市。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct route = 不繞遠路，較直接到達目的地的路線

30. direct flight — 直航航班

Practice 1

Is there a **direct flight** to Vancouver?

有沒有飛往溫哥華的直航航班？

Practice 2

A direct flight may still make an intermediate stop in some airline usage, whereas a nonstop flight has no intermediate stop.

在某些航空用語中, **direct flight** 未必等於完全不停站; **nonstop flight** 才明確表示中途不停。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct flight = 使用同一航班號直接前往目的地的航班; 實際是否中途停站需看航空安排

31. nonstop vs direct flight — 不停站 vs 直航

nonstop flight

中途完全不停站。

direct flight

不需轉乘另一航班, 但在航空業用法中有時仍可能中途停站。

This is a very useful travel distinction.

32. direct train / bus — 直達列車／巴士

Practice 1

Is there a **direct train** to the airport?

有沒有直達列車去機場?

Practice 2

Take the direct bus rather than changing downtown.

乘坐直達巴士, 不要在市中心轉車。

33. direct service — 直達服務

Practice 1

The railway operates a **direct service** between the two cities.

鐵路提供兩市之間的直達服務。

Practice 2

There is no direct service on Sundays.

星期日沒有直達班次。

34. go / fly direct — 直接前往／直飛

Here **direct** behaves adverbially.

Practice 1

We **flew direct** to Tokyo.

我們直飛東京。

Practice 2

This train goes direct to Central.

這班列車直達中央站。

H. DIRECT = STRAIGHT LINE / PHYSICAL PATH

35. direct path / line — 直線路徑；直接路線

Practice 1

The ball followed a **direct path** towards the goal.

球沿着直接路線飛向球門。

Practice 2

Keep the sensor in a direct line with the transmitter.

讓感應器與發射器保持直線對準。

36. direct sunlight — 直射陽光

Practice 1

Keep the medicine out of **direct sunlight**.

藥物應避免受到陽光直射。

Practice 2

The plant grows poorly in direct sunlight.

植物在直射陽光下生長得不太好。

37. direct light — 直射光

Practice 1

Avoid **direct light** on the screen.

避免光線直接照射螢幕。

Practice 2

Direct lighting creates stronger shadows.

直射光會產生較明顯的陰影。

38. direct hit — 直接命中; 正中

Practice 1

The ball scored a **direct hit** on the target.

球正中目標。

Practice 2

The building suffered a direct hit.

建築物受到一次直接命中。

I. DIRECT DESCENT / FAMILY LINE

39. direct descendant — 直系後代

Practice 1

She is a **direct descendant** of the founder.

她是創辦人的直系後代。

Practice 2

Direct descendants include children, grandchildren and later descendants in the same line.

直系後代包括子女、孫兒女以及同一直系中的後代。

40. direct ancestor — 直系祖先

Practice 1

The records identify one of his **direct ancestors**.

紀錄確認了他其中一位直系祖先。

Practice 2

A direct ancestor lies in a person's direct line of descent.

直系祖先屬於一個人的直接血統線。

41. direct line of descent — 直系血統

Practice 1

The title passed through the **direct line of descent**.

頭銜沿直系血統傳承。

Practice 2

The relationship is direct rather than collateral.

這是直系而不是旁系關係。

J. DIRECT = EXACT / COMPLETE / UNAMBIGUOUS RELATION

42. direct comparison — 直接比較

Practice 1

A **direct comparison** is difficult because the two groups are different.

由於兩組不同，所以很難作直接比較。

Practice 2

The study allows direct comparison between the methods.

這項研究讓兩種方法可以作直接比較。

43. **direct equivalent** — 直接對應詞／完全對等物

Practice 1

The expression has no **direct equivalent** in English.

這個表達在英文中沒有完全直接對應的說法。

Practice 2

Some cultural concepts have no direct equivalent in another language.

有些文化概念在另一種語言中沒有直接對應詞。

44. **direct parallel** — 直接類比／直接對應情況

Practice 1

There is no exact **direct parallel** in the earlier case.

較早案例中沒有完全直接對應的情況。

Practice 2

The two situations are similar but not direct parallels.

兩種情況相似，但並非完全對應。

K. DIRECT AS VERB = SHOW THE WAY

45. direct someone to a place — 指引某人去某地

A major verb sense.

Practice 1

Could you **direct me to the station**?

你可以指引我去車站嗎？

Practice 2

Staff directed visitors to the main entrance.

員工把訪客指引到正門。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct someone to X = 告訴或引導某人應往哪裡去

46. direct someone towards something — 引導某人往.....

Practice 1

The guard **directed us towards the exit**.

保安指引我們前往出口。

Practice 2

Signs direct passengers towards the platforms.

標誌引導乘客前往月台。

47. direct traffic — 指揮交通

Practice 1

Police were **directing traffic**.

警方正在指揮交通。

Practice 2

Staff directed traffic away from the blocked road.

人員把交通引離封閉道路。

L. DIRECT = GIVE INSTRUCTIONS / ORDERS

48. direct someone to do something — 指示／命令某人做某事

A major formal verb construction.

Practice 1

The manager **directed staff to stop work immediately**.

經理指示員工立即停工。

Practice 2

Employees were directed to submit the form online.

員工被指示在網上提交表格。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct someone to do X = 正式告訴或命令某人做 X

49. direct that... — 正式指示.....

Formal/legal/administrative.

Practice 1

The board **directed that the policy be reviewed**.

董事會指示重新檢討該政策。

Practice 2

The court directed that the documents be disclosed.

法院下令披露文件。

50. directive = official instruction — 指令；正式指示

Practice 1

Staff received a new **directive** from management.

員工收到管理層的新指令。

Practice 2

The directive requires departments to report monthly.

該正式指示要求各部門每月匯報。

MCQ-ready definition:

directive = 由有權力人士或機構發出的正式指示, 要求採取特定行動

51. issue a directive — 發出指令

Practice 1

The CEO **issued a directive** on data security.

行政總裁就數據保安發出指令。

Practice 2

The directive took effect immediately.

這項指令即時生效。

M. DIRECT = MANAGE / CONTROL AN ACTIVITY

52. direct an operation / project — 指揮; 管理

Practice 1

She **directed the entire operation**.

她指揮了整個行動。

Practice 2

A senior manager directs the project.

一名資深經理領導／管理這個項目。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct X = 負責決定 **X** 如何進行, 並指揮相關人員和工作

53. direct a team — 領導／指揮團隊

Practice 1

He was appointed to **direct the team**.

他獲委任領導該團隊。

Practice 2

Strong leaders direct without controlling every detail.

優秀領導者會作出方向指導, 而不是控制每一項細節。

54. direct operations — 指揮營運／行動

Practice 1

She directs regional operations.

她負責指揮地區營運。

Practice 2

The control centre directs emergency operations.

控制中心指揮緊急行動。

55. direction = management / guidance — 指導；領導

Practice 1

The project improved under her **direction**.

項目在她的領導／指導下有所改善。

Practice 2

The team needs clearer direction.

團隊需要更清晰的方向和指導。

56. under someone's direction — 在某人的指導／領導下

Practice 1

The work was completed **under the director's direction**.

工作在主管的指導下完成。

Practice 2

The research was conducted under her direction.

研究在她的領導下進行。

N. DIRECT = GUIDE ATTENTION / EFFORT / RESOURCES

57. direct attention to something — 把注意力引向某事

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 1

The report **directs attention to communication problems**.

報告把注意力引向溝通問題。

Practice 2

I'd like to direct your attention to this figure.

我想請你注意這個數字／圖表。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct attention to X = 刻意令某人的注意力集中在 X

58. direct someone's focus towards X — 把焦點引向 X

Practice 1

Leaders should **direct the discussion towards solutions**.

領導者應把討論引向解決方案。

Practice 2

The question directed attention away from blame.

問題把注意力從責任歸咎轉開。

59. direct resources towards something — 把資源投向某事

Practice 1

The company **directed more resources towards training**.

公司把更多資源投放到培訓。

Practice 2

Funds were directed towards high-priority projects.

資金被撥向高優先項目。

This overlaps with your earlier **channel resources into**.

60. direct effort towards something — 把努力集中於.....

Practice 1

The team should **direct its efforts towards the main objective**.

團隊應把努力集中在主要目標上。

Practice 2

Energy was directed towards resolving the dispute.

精力被集中用於解決爭議。

O. DIRECT WORDS / QUESTIONS / CRITICISM AT A TARGET

61. direct a question at/to someone — 向某人提出問題

Practice 1

She **directed the question at the finance manager.**

她把問題直接問財務經理。

Practice 2

Please direct technical questions to IT.

技術問題請直接向資訊科技部提出。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct a question at/to X = 指定 X 為問題的回答對象

62. direct criticism at someone — 把批評指向某人

Practice 1

Most of the criticism was **directed at management.**

大部分批評都針對管理層。

Practice 2

He directed his criticism at the system rather than individuals.

他的批評針對制度而非個人。

63. direct anger at someone — 把怒氣發向某人

Practice 1

She **directed her anger at** the wrong person.

她把怒氣發在錯的人身上。

Practice 2

Frustration was **directed towards** management.

挫折感被指向管理層。

64. direct a remark at someone — 對某人說一番針對性的話

Practice 1

The remark was **directed at one particular colleague**.

那句話是針對某一名同事說的。

Practice 2

He **directed a sarcastic comment at** the manager.

他對經理說了一句帶諷刺意味的話。

P. DIRECT A FILM / PLAY / PERFORMANCE

65. direct a film — 執導電影

A major artistic verb sense.

Practice 1

She **directed** the film.

她執導了這部電影。

Practice 2

The film was directed by a young filmmaker.

電影由一名年輕電影人執導。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct a film = 負責指導演員、鏡頭、表演和整體藝術呈現

66. direct a play — 導演舞台劇

Practice 1

He is **directing** a new play.

他正在導演一齣新舞台劇。

Practice 2

She has directed several theatre productions.

她曾執導多齣舞台作品。

67. director = film/theatre director — 導演

Practice 1

The **director** worked closely with the actors.

導演與演員緊密合作。

Practice 2

She wants to become a film director.

她想成為電影導演。

Q. DIRECTOR = ORGANISATIONAL LEADER

68. director = senior manager / board member — 董事; 主管

A major family extension.

Practice 1

She is the **finance director**.

她是財務總監。

Practice 2

The board has eight directors.

董事會有八名董事。

MCQ-ready definition:

director = 公司或機構中負責高層管理或董事會決策的人

69. managing director — 董事總經理; 常務董事

Practice 1

The **managing director** approved the restructuring.

董事總經理批准了重組。

Practice 2

Titles vary between organisations and jurisdictions.

不同公司和地區對這個職稱的實際職責可能不同。

70. executive director — 執行董事／行政總監

Practice 1

She serves as **executive director** of the organisation.

她擔任機構的行政總監／執行董事。

Practice 2

The precise meaning depends on organisational structure.

實際含義取決於機構架構。

71. non-executive director — 非執行董事

Practice 1

The board includes several **non-executive directors**.

董事會包括數名非執行董事。

Practice 2

Non-executive directors normally do not manage daily operations.

非執行董事通常不負責日常營運管理。

72. directorship — 董事職位

Practice 1

She accepted a **directorship** at another company.

她接受了另一間公司的董事職位。

Practice 2

He holds several directorships.

他擔任數個董事職務。

R. DIRECTION = WHERE SOMETHING POINTS / MOVES

73. direction = way or course towards which something moves — 方向

Practice 1

The teams proceeded in different **directions**.

各團隊朝不同方向進行工作。

Practice 2

Which direction is the station?

車站在哪個方向？

MCQ-ready definition:

direction = 某人或某物移動、面向或發展的方位／路線

74. in the direction of — 朝.....方向

Practice 1

She walked **in the direction of** the exit.

她朝出口方向走。

Practice 2

The discussion moved in a more productive direction.

討論朝一個更有建設性的方向發展。

75. change direction — 改變方向

Practice 1

The project needs to **change direction**.

項目需要改變方向。

Practice 2

The car suddenly changed direction.

汽車突然改變行駛方向。

76. sense of direction — 方向感

Practice 1

I have a terrible **sense of direction**.

我的方向感很差。

Practice 2

A good sense of direction helps when travelling.

良好的方向感在旅行時很有幫助。

S. DIRECTION = INSTRUCTIONS

77. directions = instructions — 指示; 使用說明

A major plural noun branch.

Practice 1

Follow the **directions** carefully.

仔細按照指示。

Practice 2

The package includes directions for use.

包裝內附有使用說明。

MCQ-ready definition:

directions = 告訴某人應該如何做某事的一系列指示

78. give directions — 指路

Practice 1

Could you **give me directions to the station**?

你可以告訴我怎樣去車站嗎？

Practice 2

She gave us clear directions.

她給了我們清晰的路線指示。

79. follow directions — 按照指示

Practice 1

Please **follow the directions** on the screen.

請按照螢幕上的指示。

Practice 2

The mistake happened because the directions were unclear.

錯誤發生是因為指示不清楚。

T. DIRECTION = GENERAL GUIDANCE / POLICY COURSE

80. direction = overall course / development — 發展方向; 方針

Practice 1

The company needs a clearer **strategic direction**.

公司需要更清晰的策略方向。

Practice 2

The project is moving in the wrong direction.

項目正朝錯誤方向發展。

81. strategic direction — 策略方向

Practice 1

Senior leaders set the organisation's **strategic direction**.

高層領導制定機構的策略方向。

Practice 2

The acquisition changed the company's strategic direction.

收購改變了公司的策略方向。

82. sense of direction = sense of purpose — 方向感；目標感

Figurative.

Practice 1

The team has lost its **sense of direction**.

團隊已失去方向感。

Practice 2

A shared objective gives the project a clear sense of direction.

共同目標令項目有清晰的發展方向。

U. DIRECT SPEECH / QUOTATION

83. direct speech — 直接引語

A major grammar term.

Practice 1

“I'm tired,” she said, is an example of **direct speech**.

“She said, ‘I'm tired.’” 是直接引語的例子。

Practice 2

Direct speech reproduces a speaker's actual words.

直接引語直接呈現說話者所說的話。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct speech = 直接引用某人原話的表達方式

84. direct quotation / direct quote — 直接引文

Practice 1

The essay includes a **direct quotation** from the article.

文章包含一段來自原文的直接引文。

Practice 2

Direct quotes should reproduce the source accurately.

直接引用應準確保留原文。

85. direct vs indirect speech — 直接引語 vs 間接引語

Direct:

She said, "I am tired."

Indirect:

She said that she was tired.

So:

direct speech = 原話

indirect/reported speech = 轉述

V. DIRECT OBJECT

86. direct object — 直接賓語／直接受詞

A major grammar term.

Practice 1

In "She opened the door," **the door** is the **direct object**.

在 "She opened the door" 中, **the door** 是直接賓語。

Practice 2

Some verbs take both a direct and an indirect object.

有些動詞同時可以帶直接賓語和間接賓語。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct object = 直接與動詞建立賓語關係、通常表示動作所影響的人或物

87. direct object vs indirect object

She gave **me** a **book**.

- **me** = indirect object
- **a book** = direct object

Traditional learner distinction:

direct object = 直接承受／對應動詞的事物

indirect object = 接收者／受益者等

W. ELECTRICITY

88. direct current / DC — 直流電

A major scientific sense.

Practice 1

Batteries supply **direct current**.

電池提供直流電。

Practice 2

DC flows in one overall direction rather than alternating direction periodically.

直流電的電流方向整體保持一致，而不是週期性反轉。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct current = 電荷主要沿同一方向流動的電流

89. **direct current vs alternating current** — 直流 vs 交流

DC

direct current = 直流電

AC

alternating current = 交流電

Do not translate **direct** here as “直接的” in ordinary Chinese; the established term is 直流.

X. **BANKING / PAYMENTS**

90. **direct debit** — 直接付款授權; 自動轉帳扣款

Practice 1

I pay the bill by **direct debit**.

我透過自動轉帳扣款繳費。

Practice 2

The company collects monthly fees by direct debit.

公司每月以直接扣賬方式收費。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct debit = 授權收款方直接從銀行戶口扣取款項的付款安排

91. direct deposit — 直接存款／自動入賬

Especially common in AmE.

Practice 1

My salary is paid by **direct deposit**.

我的薪金透過自動入賬發放。

Practice 2

Employees can choose direct deposit.

員工可以選擇薪金直接存入銀行戶口。

92. direct payment — 直接付款

Practice 1

The customer made a **direct payment** to the supplier.

顧客直接付款給供應商。

Practice 2

The scheme provides direct payments to eligible households.

計劃向合資格家庭提供直接款項。

Y. TAXATION / COST ACCOUNTING

93. direct tax — 直接稅

Practice 1

Income tax is generally classified as a **direct tax**.

入息稅一般被歸類為直接稅。

Practice 2

Direct taxes are imposed directly on people or organisations.

直接稅直接向個人或機構徵收。

94. direct vs indirect tax — 直接稅 vs 間接稅

Direct tax:

tax imposed directly on income/property/entity.

Indirect tax:

tax typically imposed on transactions/goods/services and often collected through intermediaries.

Exact systems vary by jurisdiction.

95. direct cost — 直接成本

Practice 1

Materials are a major **direct cost** of production.

材料是生產的重要直接成本。

Practice 2

Direct costs can be traced to a specific product or project.

直接成本可以直接歸屬到特定產品或項目。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct cost = 可以明確歸屬到某一產品、服務、項目或活動的成本

96. direct labour — 直接人工

Practice 1

Direct labour costs increased.

直接人工成本上升。

Practice 2

Direct labour is labour directly involved in producing the product.

直接人工指直接參與生產產品的勞動。

97. direct material — 直接材料

Practice 1

Steel is a **direct material** in this product.

鋼材是這項產品的直接材料。

Practice 2

Direct materials can be traced to the finished item.

直接材料可直接歸屬於製成品。

Z. INVESTMENT

98. direct investment — 直接投資

Practice 1

The company made a **direct investment** in the overseas business.

公司對海外企業作出直接投資。

Practice 2

Direct investment can involve acquiring a lasting interest or significant influence in an enterprise.

直接投資可以涉及取得企業的長期權益或重大影響力。

99. foreign direct investment / FDI — 外商直接投資

Practice 1

The country attracted more **foreign direct investment**.

該國吸引了更多外商直接投資。

Practice 2

FDI differs from simply buying small quantities of foreign securities.

外商直接投資與單純購買少量海外證券不同。

AA. MARKETING / SALES

100. direct marketing — 直接營銷

You have seen this under **market**, but it belongs strongly to the **direct** family.

Practice 1

Email is often used for **direct marketing**.

電郵經常用於直接營銷。

Practice 2

Direct marketing communicates with customers without relying only on broad mass advertising.

直接營銷直接向特定顧客傳遞市場訊息。

101. direct sales — 直接銷售

Practice 1

The company uses **direct sales** rather than distributors.

公司採用直接銷售而非透過分銷商。

Practice 2

Online stores allow more direct sales to consumers.

網店讓企業更容易直接向消費者銷售。

102. direct-to-consumer / DTC — 直接面向消費者

Practice 1

The brand adopted a **direct-to-consumer model**.

品牌採用直接面向消費者的模式。

Practice 2

DTC companies sell without traditional retail intermediaries.

DTC 公司不經傳統零售中介，直接向消費者銷售。

103. direct channel — 直接渠道

From your **channel** family.

Practice 1

The website is the company's main **direct channel**.

網站是公司的主要直接渠道。

Practice 2

Direct channels allow closer contact with customers.

直接渠道讓企業與顧客有更緊密接觸。

AB. POLITICS / GOVERNANCE

104. direct democracy — 直接民主

Practice 1

In **direct democracy**, citizens vote directly on certain decisions.

在直接民主制度中，公民直接就某些事項投票。

Practice 2

Direct democracy differs from representative democracy.

直接民主與代議民主不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct democracy = 公民直接參與某些政策或公共決策，而非完全由當選代表代為決定的制度

105. direct election — 直接選舉

Practice 1

The office is filled by **direct election**.

該職位由直接選舉產生。

Practice 2

Voters choose the officeholder directly.

選民直接選出該職位的人選。

106. direct action — 直接行動

An established social/political/labour term.

Practice 1

The group chose **direct action** rather than relying only on formal lobbying.

該團體選擇採取直接行動，而不是只依賴正式游說。

Practice 2

In labour contexts, strikes can be described as forms of direct action.

在勞工語境中，罷工可被視為某種直接行動。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct action = 不只透過代表、申請或一般制度程序，而直接採取行動以造成改變或施加壓力

AC. MATHEMATICS

107. direct proportion — 正比例

Practice 1

Distance is in **direct proportion** to time when speed is constant.

速度固定時，距離與時間成正比例。

Practice 2

If one quantity doubles and the other doubles, they may be directly proportional.

如果一個量加倍時另一個量也加倍，兩者可能成正比。

108. directly proportional — 成正比的

Practice 1

Output is not always **directly proportional** to effort.

產出並不總是與努力成正比。

Practice 2

The variables are directly proportional.

這些變量成正比。

109. direct variation — 正變; 正比例變化

Practice 1

The equation represents **direct variation**.

這條方程表示正比例變化。

Practice 2

In direct variation, one variable changes in constant proportion to another.

在正變關係中，一個變量按固定比例隨另一變量改變。

AD. LAW

110. direct examination — 主問; 直接詢問

Especially AmE legal usage.

Practice 1

The witness testified during **direct examination**.

證人在主問階段作證。

Practice 2

Direct examination is normally conducted by the side that called the witness.

主問通常由傳召該證人的一方進行。

111. direct evidence — 直接證據

Already covered generally, but especially important in law.

Practice 1

Eyewitness testimony can sometimes constitute **direct evidence**.

目擊證供有時可以構成直接證據。

Practice 2

Direct and circumstantial evidence are distinct evidential categories.

直接證據和間接／環境證據是不同證據類別。

AE. DIRECTLY

112. directly = without intermediary — 直接地

Practice 1

Contact me **directly**.

請直接聯絡我。

Practice 2

Customers can order directly from the manufacturer.

顧客可以直接向製造商訂購。

MCQ-ready definition:

directly = 中間不經過其他人、步驟或媒介地

113. directly involved — 直接參與

Practice 1

She was **directly involved** in the negotiations.

她直接參與了談判。

Practice 2

Not everyone was directly involved in the decision.

並非每個人都直接參與該決定。

114. directly responsible — 直接負責

Practice 1

The manager is **directly responsible** for the department.

經理對該部門直接負責。

Practice 2

Who is directly responsible for approving this?

誰直接負責批准這件事？

115. directly related — 直接相關

Practice 1

The two issues are **directly related**.

兩個問題直接相關。

Practice 2

Performance is directly related to several factors.

表現與數個因素直接相關。

116. directly connected / linked — 直接相連／關聯

Practice 1

The delays are **directly linked to poor planning**.

延誤與規劃不善直接相關。

Practice 2

These systems are directly connected.

這些系統直接連接。

117. directly opposite — 正對面；完全相反

Two useful senses.

Physical:

The bank is **directly opposite the station**.

銀行就在車站正對面。

Figurative:

Their views are directly opposite.

他們的觀點完全相反。

118. directly above/below — 正上方／正下方

Practice 1

The office is **directly above** the shop.

辦公室就在商店的正上方。

Practice 2

The parking area is directly below the building.

停車場就在大樓的正下方。

119. directly before/after — 緊接之前／之後

Practice 1

The meeting takes place **directly after** lunch.

會議在午餐後立即／緊接着舉行。

Practice 2

Speak to me directly before the presentation.

簡報前立即來找我。

120. directly = immediately — 立即；馬上

More common in some varieties/registers than others.

Practice 1

I'll deal with it **directly**.

我會立即處理。

Practice 2

She came directly after receiving the message.

她收到訊息後立即過來。

AF. REDIRECT

121. redirect = direct to a different place/target — 重新導向；轉送

Practice 1

The website **redirected me to the login page**.

網站把我重新導向登入頁面。

Practice 2

Calls were redirected to another office.

電話被轉駁到另一個辦公室。

MCQ-ready definition:

redirect = 改變原本方向，把人、資料、資源等轉往另一目的地

122. redirect resources — 重新調配資源

Practice 1

Resources were **redirected towards urgent tasks**.

資源被重新調配到緊急任務。

Practice 2

The company redirected investment into digital services.

公司把投資轉移到數碼服務。

123. redirect attention — 轉移注意力

Practice 1

The manager redirected attention towards solutions.

經理把注意力重新引向解決方案。

Practice 2

The question redirected the discussion.

這個問題把討論轉向另一方向。

AG. MISDIRECT

124. misdirect = send/guide in the wrong direction — 指錯方向；誤導

Practice 1

The sign **misdirected** visitors.

標誌把訪客指錯了方向。

Practice 2

The parcel was misdirected to the wrong office.

包裹被錯誤轉送到另一間辦公室。

125. misdirect attention — 把注意力錯誤引向.....

Practice 1

The report may **misdirect attention away from the real cause**.

報告可能把注意力錯誤地從真正原因移開。

Practice 2

Anger was misdirected at junior staff.

怒氣被錯誤地發洩在初級員工身上。

126. misdirected anger / effort — 錯誤指向的憤怒／努力

Practice 1

His anger was **misdirected**.

他的憤怒發錯了對象。

Practice 2

Misdirected effort can waste time.

用錯方向的努力可能浪費時間。

AH. INDIRECT

127. indirect = not direct; through intermediaries — 間接的

Practice 1

The policy had an **indirect effect** on employees.

政策對員工產生了間接影響。

Practice 2

We received the information through an indirect channel.

我們透過間接渠道取得資料。

128. indirect communication — 間接溝通；較婉轉的溝通

Practice 1

Some cultures prefer more **indirect communication**.

有些文化較偏好婉轉的溝通方式。

Practice 2

Indirect wording can sometimes reduce confrontation.

較間接婉轉的措辭有時可以減少對抗。

This is the natural opposite of your passage sense of **direct**.

129. indirect result / effect — 間接結果／影響

Practice 1

The delay had several **indirect effects**.

延誤帶來數個間接影響。

Practice 2

Lower morale was an indirect consequence of poor leadership.

士氣下降是管理不善的一項間接後果。

130. indirectly — 間接地

Practice 1

The decision **indirectly affected** everyone.

這項決定間接影響所有人。

Practice 2

She was indirectly involved in the project.

她間接參與了項目。

Important distinction 1: direct vs straightforward

direct

says the point openly and clearly.

straightforward

can describe:

1. communication that is honest/direct;
2. a task that is simple and uncomplicated.

direct person
說話直接的人

straightforward task
簡單易明的任務

So they overlap only partly.

Important distinction 2: direct vs frank

You have already curated **frank**.

direct

focuses on **not avoiding the point**.

frank

focuses on **openly expressing the truth/opinion**, even if uncomfortable.

a direct answer
直接回答

a frank discussion
坦誠討論

Someone can be direct without revealing much personal feeling.

Important distinction 3: direct vs blunt

direct

neutral or positive.

blunt

so direct that it may sound insensitive or rude.

She's direct.

她說話直率。

She's blunt.

她說話太直／不太顧及感受。

This is especially important for your passage.

Important distinction 4: direct vs rude

direct

communication style.

rude

violates politeness/respect.

A direct person can still be polite.

So:

direct ≠ rude.

Important distinction 5: direct vs assertive

assertive

confidently expresses needs and views while respecting others.

direct

focuses on explicitness.

A person can be:

- direct but not assertive,

- assertive but tactful,
 - direct and assertive.
-

Important distinction 6: direct vs aggressive

direct

clear and explicit.

aggressive

forceful, hostile or overly confrontational.

Your passage's **direct employees** are not necessarily aggressive.

Important distinction 7: direct vs diplomatic

direct

says the point plainly.

diplomatic

chooses wording carefully to avoid unnecessary offence/conflict.

direct: "This plan will not work."

diplomatic: "I think there may be some challenges with this approach."

Neither is automatically better; context matters.

Important distinction 8: direct vs honest

honest

truthful.

direct

straight to the point.

Someone can be honest but tactful/indirect.

Someone can also be direct but factually wrong.

Important distinction 9: direct vs clear

clear

easy to understand.

direct

not indirect or evasive.

A direct statement can still be poorly worded and unclear.

Important distinction 10: direct vs concise

direct

gets to the point.

concise

uses few words.

A direct explanation may be long; a concise answer may still avoid a sensitive issue.

Important distinction 11: direct communication vs professional communication

From your earlier **professional** entry:

direct communication

explicit and straightforward.

professional communication

appropriate to work standards.

The best workplace communication can be:

direct + respectful + professional

rather than blunt or hostile.

Important distinction 12: direct vs immediate

direct

without intermediary.

immediate

without time delay / very close.

direct supervisor
直屬主管

immediate response
立即回應

They sometimes overlap but describe different relationships.

Important distinction 13: direct cause vs immediate cause

direct cause

causal chain is not mediated by another major cause.

immediate cause

cause closest in time or causal sequence to the event.

They may be the same, but not necessarily.

Important distinction 14: direct vs indirect cause

Direct:

A caused B.

Indirect:

A influenced C, which contributed to B.

So **indirect** does not mean unreal or unimportant.

Important distinction 15: direct evidence vs circumstantial evidence

direct evidence

directly supports the fact to be established.

circumstantial evidence

requires an inference from surrounding facts.

Both can be valuable evidence.

Important distinction 16: direct experience vs firsthand experience

These are very close.

firsthand experience

especially emphasizes personal experience rather than hearsay.

direct experience

broader but similar.

firsthand knowledge
direct knowledge

Both contrast with second-hand information.

Important distinction 17: direct access vs easy access

direct access

no intermediary.

easy access

not difficult to obtain/reach.

Something may be easy but still indirect.

Important distinction 18: direct report

This does **not** mean:

a report/document that is direct.

In management:

direct report = employee who reports directly to you

A highly important workplace lexicalized sense.

Important distinction 19: direct flight vs nonstop flight

Critical travel distinction:

nonstop

no intermediate stop.

direct

no change of flight number / through service, but may in some airline contexts include a stop.

In ordinary conversation people often loosely use **direct** to mean nonstop, but the technical distinction remains useful.

Important distinction 20: direct route vs shortest route

A **direct route** avoids unnecessary detours.

It is often the shortest, but not logically always the absolute shortest measurable route.

Important distinction 21: direct sunlight vs daylight

direct sunlight

sun's rays shine directly onto something.

daylight

natural light during daytime, including indirect light.

A room can have daylight without direct sunlight.

Important distinction 22: direct descendant vs relative

relative

any family relation.

direct descendant

person descended through a continuous parent→child line.

Cousins are relatives, but not direct descendants of each other.

Important distinction 23: direct someone to vs tell someone where

direct someone to X

more formal and often suggests guidance.

tell someone where X is

ordinary everyday expression.

Reception directed me to Room 5.
接待處指引我去 5 號房。

Important distinction 24: direct someone to do vs ask someone to do

ask

request.

direct

formally instruct, often from authority.

asked staff to leave
請員工離開

directed staff to leave
指示／命令員工離開

Direct is stronger and more formal.

Important distinction 25: direct vs order as verbs

order

explicit command.

direct

formal instruction, often less forceful in tone but still authoritative.

In legal/administrative contexts, **direct** can nevertheless be effectively mandatory.

Important distinction 26: direct attention to vs draw attention to

Very close.

draw attention to

make someone notice.

direct attention to

guide/focus attention toward something.

I'd like to direct your attention to page 4.

has a controlled, formal tone.

Important distinction 27: direct resources vs channel resources

From your **channel** entry:

direct resources towards X

decide where resources should go.

channel resources into X

emphasizes resources flowing/concentrating into that destination.

Very close, but **channel** has the metaphor of flow.

Important distinction 28: direct a team vs lead a team

lead

broader leadership:

- motivate,
- influence,
- guide.

direct

emphasizes deciding what is done and giving direction/instructions.

A leader can empower others rather than directly directing every action.

Important distinction 29: direct a company vs manage a company

manage

run day-to-day work/resources.

direct

set/control direction and instruct how major work proceeds.

The distinction varies by organizational context.

Important distinction 30: director vs manager

manager

usually manages an operational area/team.

director

often more senior or board-level.

But titles vary enormously between organisations.

Do not assume every **director** sits on a legal board.

Important distinction 31: director = director vs film director

Same noun, very different domains:

finance director
財務總監

film director
電影導演

Context decides.

Important distinction 32: direction = physical direction vs guidance

Compare:

Which **direction** is north?
北方是哪個方向？

The team needs more **direction**.
團隊需要更多指導／明確方向。

Same noun, literal → figurative extension.

Important distinction 33: directions vs direction

direction singular

often:

- orientation/course,
- general guidance.

directions plural

often:

- step-by-step instructions,
- route instructions.

strategic direction
策略方向

cooking directions
烹調指示

Important distinction 34: directive vs direction

direction

can mean general guidance.

directive

formal authoritative instruction.

management direction
管理方向／指導

management directive
管理層正式指令

Important distinction 35: direct speech vs direct communication

direct speech

technical grammar term = quoted original words.

direct communication

communication without intermediaries or excessive indirectness.

Not the same thing.

Important distinction 36: direct object

This does not mean:

a physical object that is close/direct.

It is a fixed grammar term.

She opened **the door**.

the door = direct object.

Important distinction 37: direct current

This is also lexicalized.

It does not mean:

electricity sent “directly” to someone.

It is the established technical opposite of:

alternating current.

Important distinction 38: direct debit vs bank transfer

direct debit

payee is authorised to collect money from your account.

bank transfer

payer actively sends money.

Different payment mechanisms.

Important distinction 39: direct cost vs indirect cost

direct cost

traceable to a specific product/project.

indirect cost

supports wider operations and cannot be conveniently attributed to one item.

Example:

wood used in one table = direct material

factory rent = indirect/overhead cost

Important distinction 40: direct tax vs indirect tax

direct

levied directly on person/entity/income/property.

indirect

attached to transactions/goods/services and commonly passed through market transactions.

The exact classification depends on the tax system.

Important distinction 41: direct marketing vs advertising

direct marketing

targets identifiable customers directly.

advertising

can be broad mass communication.

Direct marketing may use:

- email,
 - SMS,
 - mail,
 - targeted offers.
-

Important distinction 42: direct sales vs retail distribution

direct sales

producer/company sells straight to customer.

indirect distribution

intermediaries are involved:

- distributor,
 - wholesaler,
 - retailer.
-

Important distinction 43: direct investment vs portfolio investment

Broadly:

direct investment

investor seeks a lasting interest/significant influence in an enterprise.

portfolio investment

mainly holds securities as financial assets without the same level of control/influence.

Important distinction 44: direct proportion

This does **not** merely mean:

“closely related.”

Mathematically it has a specific structure:

$$y = kx$$

for a constant k .

Important distinction 45: directly related vs directly proportional

directly related

general: one is closely/directly connected with the other.

directly proportional

specific mathematical relationship.

Do not use them interchangeably.

Important distinction 46: directly opposite

Two interpretations:

Place:

directly opposite the station
就在車站正對面

Opinion/meaning:

directly opposite views
完全相反的觀點

Important distinction 47: direct vs directly

Adjective:

direct contact
直接接觸

Adverb:

contact me directly
直接聯絡我

Important distinction 48: direct as adverb vs directly

Both occur in some patterns:

fly **direct** to Hong Kong
直飛香港

contact Hong Kong **directly**
直接聯絡香港方面

Direct as adverb is especially common with travel/routes and some commercial constructions.

Important distinction 49: directly = immediately

In some formal/British-influenced usages:

I'll come directly.

can mean:

我馬上來。

But in many contexts modern learners will more naturally use:

- immediately,
- right away,
- straight away.

So this sense should be recognized, but not overused.

Important distinction 50: redirect vs direct

direct

send something toward a destination.

redirect

change it from its previous destination to a new one.

direct the call to sales
把電話轉到銷售部

redirect the call to finance instead
改為把電話轉到財務部

Important distinction 51: misdirect vs mislead

misdirect

send/direct toward the wrong:

- place,
- person,
- target,
- focus.

mislead

cause someone to form a wrong belief.

parcel was misdirected
包裹寄錯地方

advertisement was misleading
廣告令人產生錯誤理解

Important distinction 52: misdirected anger

This does not mean the anger itself is unreal.

It means:

the anger is aimed at the wrong person or cause

Important distinction 53: direct vs indirect communication in your passage

Your passage describes personality differences:

Some employees are **direct** and fast-paced; others are cautious and reflective.

Here, **direct** is primarily about **interpersonal communication style**.

A direct worker may say:

“This deadline is unrealistic. We need two more days.”

A more indirect worker may say:

“I wonder whether it might be worth reviewing the timeline.”

Both can communicate the same concern.

The difference lies in:

how explicitly the message is stated

Important distinction 54: direct does not mean “correct”

A direct person may still be:

- mistaken,
- unfair,
- poorly informed.

Direct describes style, not truth.

Important distinction 55: direct does not mean “emotionless”

Someone can communicate very directly while being:

- angry,
- friendly,
- calm,
- sympathetic.

It refers to explicitness, not emotional tone.

Important distinction 56: direct does not mean “simple”

A direct explanation can still be technically complex.

It simply avoids:

- unnecessary detours,
 - evasiveness,
 - ambiguity about the main point.
-

Important distinction 57: direct in your passage

The paragraph discusses interpersonal conflict:

Some employees are **direct and fast-paced**; others are **cautious and reflective**.

The contrast is deliberate.

direct employee

- states views quickly and explicitly,
- may prefer fast decisions,
- may challenge ideas openly.

cautious/reflective employee

- takes more time,
- weighs consequences,
- may choose softer wording.

Neither style is inherently superior.

The problem arises when people interpret:

directness as aggression

or:

caution as weakness/indecision

instead of understanding them as different working and communication styles.

Family-extension note

The **direct** family has several major modern semantic branches:

1. straightforward communication

- direct person
- direct answer
- direct manner

2. without intermediary

- direct contact
- direct access
- direct channel

3. causal connection

- direct cause
- direct result
- direct consequence

4. first-hand relation

- direct experience
- direct evidence

5. organisational relation

- direct responsibility
- direct report
- direct manager

6. route/travel

- direct route
- direct flight

- go direct

7. physical line/light

- direct sunlight
- direct hit

8. family descent

- direct descendant
- direct ancestor

9. guide somewhere

- direct someone to X
- direct traffic

10. give instructions

- direct someone to do X
- directive

11. manage/lead

- direct operations
- under someone's direction

12. focus something

- direct attention
- direct resources

13. target speech/emotion

- direct criticism at
- direct anger at

14. arts

- direct a film
- director

15. corporate governance

- director
- directorship

16. direction

- physical direction
- strategic direction
- directions/instructions

17. grammar

- direct speech
- direct object

18. electricity

- direct current

19. banking

- direct debit
- direct deposit

20. accounting/tax

- direct cost
- direct tax

21. investment

- foreign direct investment

22. marketing/sales

- direct marketing
- direct sales

23. governance

- direct democracy
- direct election
- direct action

24. mathematics

- direct proportion
- directly proportional

25. law

- direct examination
- direct evidence

26. adverb family

- directly
- directly involved
- directly opposite

27. change direction

- redirect

28. wrong direction

- misdirect
- misdirected anger

29. opposite family

- indirect
- indirectly

For your passage, the exact branch is:

direct = communicating opinions and needs openly and explicitly rather than indirectly or cautiously

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
direct (communication)	直接的; 直率的	straightforward
direct person	說話直接的人	style

direct manner	直接的方式	style
direct answer	直接回答	no evasion
direct question	直接問題	explicit question
direct criticism	直接批評	explicit criticism
direct communication	直接溝通	explicit exchange
be direct with someone	對某人直言	speak plainly
direct contact	直接接觸／聯絡	no intermediary
direct access	直接存取／接觸	no intermediary
direct connection	直接連接／關聯	connection
direct link	直接關係	link
direct cause	直接原因	causation
direct result	直接結果	consequence
direct consequence	直接後果	effect
direct experience	親身經驗	firsthand
direct knowledge	第一手了解	firsthand
direct evidence	直接證據	evidential relation
direct involvement	直接參與	involvement
direct responsibility	直接責任	responsibility
direct control	直接控制	control
direct supervision	直接監督	oversight
direct report	直接下屬	organisational hierarchy
direct manager	直屬經理	hierarchy

direct route	直接路線	no detour
direct flight	直航航班	through flight
direct train/bus	直達列車／巴士	no transfer
go/fly direct	直接前往／直飛	adverbial
direct sunlight	直射陽光	physical
direct hit	直接命中	physical
direct descendant	直系後代	genealogy
direct ancestor	直系祖先	genealogy
direct equivalent	直接對應詞	equivalence
direct someone to X	指引某人去 X	guidance
direct traffic	指揮交通	guidance
direct someone to do X	指示某人做 X	instruction
directive	指令；正式指示	authoritative instruction
direct an operation	指揮行動	manage/control
direct a team	領導／指揮團隊	management
direction (guidance)	指導；方向	leadership
direct attention to	把注意力引向	focus
direct resources towards	把資源投向	allocation
direct criticism at	把批評指向	target
direct anger at	把怒氣發向	target
direct a film	執導電影	arts
director (film)	導演	arts

director (business)	董事／總監	management
directorship	董事職位	office
direction (physical)	方向	orientation
directions	指示；路線說明	instructions
strategic direction	策略方向	organisational course
direct speech	直接引語	grammar
direct quotation	直接引文	quotation
direct object	直接賓語	grammar
direct current	直流電	electricity
direct debit	直接扣賬／自動扣款	banking
direct deposit	直接存款／自動入賬	banking
direct tax	直接稅	taxation
direct cost	直接成本	accounting
direct labour	直接人工	accounting
direct material	直接材料	accounting
direct investment	直接投資	finance
foreign direct investment	外商直接投資	finance
direct marketing	直接營銷	marketing
direct sales	直接銷售	sales
direct-to-consumer	直接面向消費者	business
direct democracy	直接民主	governance
direct election	直接選舉	governance

direct action	直接行動	collective action
direct proportion	正比例	mathematics
directly proportional	成正比	mathematics
direct examination	主問	law
directly	直接地	adverb
directly involved	直接參與	involvement
directly responsible	直接負責	responsibility
directly related	直接相關	relation
directly opposite	正對面／完全相反	position/opposition
redirect	重新導向；轉送	change destination
misdirect	指錯方向；誤導	wrong destination
misdirected anger	發錯對象的怒氣	wrong target
indirect	間接的；婉轉的	opposite of direct
indirect communication	間接／婉轉溝通	communication style
indirectly	間接地	adverb

For your original sentence

Some employees are **direct** and fast-paced; others are cautious and reflective.

Here:

direct = 在溝通時會迅速、明確地說出自己的意見、要求或不同意見，不太使用迂迴或高度婉轉的表達方式

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

有些員工說話直接、直率，做事節奏快；另一些則較謹慎、較善於反思。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

direct = 直截了當, 把真正意思明確說出來

frank = 坦白誠實地說出真實想法

assertive = 有自信地表達立場而尊重他人

blunt = 直接得可能令人覺得不顧感受

aggressive = 帶攻擊性、強逼性

diplomatic = 措辭婉轉, 盡量避免衝突

indirect = 不直接明說, 較含蓄婉轉

And in the teamwork paragraph, the important point is:

direct ≠ rude

cautious ≠ weak

They are contrasting **communication and working styles**. Conflict arises when one style interprets the other negatively rather than adapting to it.